

Keyboard phone stand?

The Skeltr gaming keyboard from Roccato allow users to let them prop up their smartphone while gaming. <http://dgit.in/Skeltr>



Meet the new Leica

Purists, rejoice! The Leica M-P - a 24 megapixel full frame camera with a CMOS sensor has just been announced. <http://dgit.in/LeicaWowca>



Acer Travelmate P645

Our time with the P645 was one of mixed rewards and frustrations. We liked the battery life, loved the keyboard and were very impressed by the temperature management. At the same time, the lack of a touchscreen was a little frustrating.

We were constantly disappointed by the screen, despite the fact that the machine comes with good business features such as fingerprint scanner, TPM security, and more.

The Acer Travelmate P645 is a good device, and better than most business laptops. It's good for both those who work at their desks, or even those who travel. If all you want is a lightweight laptop that'll give you great battery life and a very good keyboard, this one won't disappoint you.

DELL VOSTRO 14 3446

This is the only business laptop in the comparison that we can call colourful, simply because it comes with a maroon screen lid. The Vostro 14 is nicely built, with a chunky exterior, and a textured plastic screen lid that's different from any of the other business laptops. If you want any semblance of colour on your business laptop, look no further than the Dell Vostro 14

3446. No complaints from the build of the device, apart from the fact that it's not an ultraportable and feels rather heavy for a 14-inch laptop.

The Dell Vostro 14 has one glaring omission - while every other laptop in this comparison comes with an inbuilt TPM (trusted platform module) to enable hardware level data encryption, the Vostro, unfortunately, skimps on that feature (probably because of its entry-level pricing). It's a small feature, but something that business laptop seekers attach a lot of importance towards.

Apart from this hiccup, the rest is pretty much smooth sailing on the Dell Vostro 14 3446. Despite being the most inexpensive laptop of the bunch, the Vostro

manages to beat everyone else (including laptops that are priced more than 2.5 times higher) in terms of pure brute performance. This is made possible thanks to a large part because of the bundled discrete GPU it has - NVIDIA GeForce 820M. As you can see from the table, it is clearly a big differentiator in propelling the Vostro right at the top of our performance chart.

The Dell Vostro laptop also comes with MaxxAudio for better-than-average audio, anti-glare screen for better viewing experience, and these features do make a difference for the better. It comes with all the features one would expect it to have, some geared towards business which come in handy, but the laptop slightly disappoints in two key departments - its keyboard and touchpad, both of which aren't as great as some of the other laptops in this comparison. Their feedback just doesn't feel top-notch, and maybe we're expecting too much from a sub-50k laptop. But it's definitely something to think about for Dell's engineers and product design guys to work on in the future. However, like we said, there's no other business laptop that can

come near the Dell Vostro 14 right now and its price,

too, is unbeatable, and for that reason alone this is a great laptop to purchase.

HP PROBOOK 640 G1

Right out of the box, the HP ProBook is dressed in the look and feel that pretty much sums up any business laptop. Having said that, it has a nice matte finish on its shell, which doesn't attract any sort of fingerprints (which is something that you can't say about the shiny, glossy laptops that are made for home use). The colour-scheme of the HP ProBook is dark grey overall, and its two-toned silver aluminium finish lends it a bit of class and elevates its desirability from a visual and aesthetics perspective, at least over the other business laptops in this article.

The HP ProBook seems well built for a laptop that sells at the mid-range segment of business laptops, which is encouraging to see. If only more brands could work towards elevating the quality of builds seen on non-ultrabook laptops, the computing world will be better off. The central hinge and spine that hold the ProBook 640 G1's screen and bottom chassis together is quite tight, but doesn't totally stop the screen from vibrating whenever you are typing furiously. This is acceptable and not irritating enough to spoil your experience.

For a 14-inch notebook, the HP ProBook 640 G1 isn't the most portable of the lot. Compared to the Acer Travelmate P645, Toshiba Portege or Lenovo ThinkPad S1 Yoga, the HP ProBook (and even the Dell Vostro 14, for that matter) are a touch heavier - not uncomfortably so, but in an Ultrabook infested world, the HP Pro-



Dell Vostro 14 3446